and others can't. And if you are one of those who *can* handle it, then you have to do what it takes to get the team through.

The question you're probably asking is: If that kind of strategy has worked for me successfully in pressure games, why haven't I applied it to all the other games I've played? Fact is, I'm an instinctive type of player who just goes out and plays. I don't think too much about what I am doing once I'm out there, to be honest. Sometimes I play a shot and I don't know why I'm playing it. No idea. I just play it.

Indian batsman Virender Sehwag is similar in his approach, and he's one of the highest-scoring batsmen in Test and ODI cricket in recent years. He only knows one way to play, and that's his way. His game is either going to come off or it's not, whether it is a Test match or an ODI. He's not going to change his approach from one match to another. I mean, the guy doesn't know how to play himself in – he just blasts away from ball one.

Chris Gayle and Brendon McCullum are the same, as were Adam Gilchrist and Matthew Hayden when they were playing Test cricket. They don't have the finesse of a Sachin Tendulkar, but what they do have are terrific timing and a great eye. They just go out there and murder the ball.

I've got to tell you, it's a *great* feeling when you know that today everything is going to come together and you are going to smash the ball all over the place. In the Proteas 2009 tour to Australia, for example, Mark Boucher came up to me during the third ODI at the Sydney Cricket Ground and said, 'Hersch, entertain us tonight. We're chasing 270, and no one's chased down 270 at Sydney before.' And I was like, 'Yes, Bouchie, I do believe I'll be playing a few shots today.'

So I went out with that mindset. I played myself in for the first over or two, and then, after I mishit a drive to the fielder at point, who promptly dropped it, I said to myself, 'Okay, boet, this is your cue. Now you've got to play shots.' Shaun Tait was running in, and the next minute I'm walking up the pitch and popping the ball back over his head for a one-bouncer. The SCG is a big ground, and Tait wasn't bowling slow either – around 149 km/h – and I was just like, *bang*! So I thought, okay, cool, we're starting to get going here. The next ball, I ran down at him again and again hit the ball straight over his head for another one-bounce four. And I just took off from there. I ended up getting 64 in no time at all.

Looking back over my career, these are the games that stand out the most for me …